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ELECTRONIC DEVICE AND ELECTRONIC DEVICE CONTROL METHOD

Abstract

Provided is an electronic device such as a storage apparatus coping with, with a simple configuration, a situation where data transfer cannot be performed because of an occurrence of an abnormality in the connection using a connector or the like, at the time of occurrence of a shock due to an earthquake or the like. The present invention is applied to an electronic device in which a drive that stores data and a control board having disposed thereon a controller that controls data transfer between the drive and another apparatus are connected via a connector. The electronic device includes: an acceleration sensor; and a vibration sensing processing section that controls a state of communication between the drive and the controller to temporarily stop data transfer performed by the drive, for a period during which a possibility of occurrence of an ongoing abnormality exists in the connection using the connector or the like, when the acceleration sensor has sensed an acceleration of exceeding an upper-limit threshold, and causes the temporarily stopped data transfer to resume when the acceleration sensor has sensed an acceleration of equal to or lower than a lower-limit threshold.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

[0001] The present invention relates to an electronic device and an electronic device control method.

2. Description of the Related Art

[0002] As one type of electronic device, various types of storage apparatus that store large volumes of data have been developed. Storage apparatuses typically use solid state drives (SSDs) or hard disk drives (HDDs).

[0003] These storage apparatuses ensure required recording capacities by combining a plurality of drives such as SSDs or HDDs, and include controllers that control the plurality of drives.

[0004] A plurality of drives and controllers are connected to a PCB (Printed circuit board) called a backboard via connectors. Note that a plurality of PCBs of the controller also are prepared in some cases in order to give an apparatus redundancy.

[0005] In a case where a plurality of drives and control boards are connected via connectors, there is a possibility that an abnormality occurs in data transfer via the connectors in a case where a shock due to an earthquake or the like is applied during the data transfer.

[0006] Specifically, although a connector has a structure of mechanically avoiding disconnection due to a certain degree of vibration, a vibration causes chattering, and accordingly the data transfer state becomes unstable in some cases. Particularly, in recent years, there has been a tendency that a transfer rate at the time of data transfer increases, and a connector itself has been miniaturized.

Accordingly, a case increases where correct data transfer cannot be performed at the time of occurrence of a vibration.

[0007] In a case where an abnormality has occurred during data transfer, and the data transfer is interrupted in a storage apparatus, it is necessary to check entire recorded data since it cannot be known which part of data is lost. Because of this, each storage apparatus requires a very long time until the completion of data transfer. In addition, there can also be a case where the data transfer is not recovered automatically depending on the occurrence status of an abnormality. Accordingly, it is preferable if storage apparatuses cope with a shock such as an earthquake.

[0008] JP-2005-182773-A describes a technology in which an acceleration sensor detects a prediction of possibility of receiving shock received by an information processing apparatus, the shock being due to a fall or the like. According to the technology described in JP-2005-182773-A, a sector where transfer is being performed, and where an influence of a shock due to a fall or the like may be received is determined. Then, information of the sector is caused to be written in a register, and when the transfer is resumed, the transfer is resumed starting from data stored on the register.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0009] According to the technology described in JP-2005-182773-A, being in the middle of falling

of the apparatus is sensed, and the data is stored on the register before the falling apparatus hits a floor or the like and receives a shock. However, the technology described in JP-2005-182773-A cannot cope with a shock that occurs without a sign as in a case of earthquake.

[0010] Conventionally, in order to cope with a shock such as an earthquake, there has been such a structure of a storage apparatus that a storage apparatus is arranged via a seismic isolation apparatus so as to be prevented from shaking even if an earthquake occurs. However, if such a seismic isolation apparatus is used, there is a problem that the configuration becomes undesirably expensive because the scale of the storage apparatus becomes large.

[0011] In view of these matters, an object of the present invention is to provide an electronic device and an electronic device control method that make it possible, with a simple configuration, to cope with a situation where data transfer cannot be performed in an electrical device such as a storage apparatus at the time of occurrence of a shock such as an earthquake.

[0012] In order to solve the problems described above, for example, configurations described in claims are adopted.

[0013] The present application includes a plurality of means for solving the problems described above, and one example thereof is an electronic device having a configuration in which a drive that stores data and a control board having disposed thereon a controller that controls data transfer between the drive and another device are connected to each other via a connector, the electronic device including: an acceleration sensor that senses occurrence of a vibration; and a vibration sensing processing section that causes the controller to control a state of communication between the drive and the controller to temporarily stop data transfer performed between the drive and the controller, when the acceleration sensor has sensed an acceleration exceeding an upper-limit threshold, and causes the temporarily stopped data transfer to resume when the acceleration sensor has sensed an acceleration of equal to or lower than a lower-limit threshold.

[0014] According to the present invention, it is possible to effectively prevent occurrence of a failure of data transfer due to occurrence of a shock such as an earthquake by controlling a state of communication on the basis of a vibration status sensed by an acceleration sensor.

[0015] Problems, configurations, and advantages other than those described above are made clear by the following explanation of an embodiment.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0016] FIG. 1 is a side view of the configuration of an electronic device according to an embodiment of the present invention;

[0017] FIG. 2 is a top view of the configuration of the electronic device according to the embodiment of the present invention;

[0018] FIG. 3 is a block diagram depicting an apparatus configuration example of the electronic device according to the embodiment of the present invention;

[0019] FIG. 4 is a flowchart depicting an example of a control process of the electronic device according to the embodiment of the present invention;

[0020] FIG. 5 is a sequence diagram depicting a setting example of a state of communication according to the embodiment of the present invention;

[0021] FIG. 6 is a figure depicting an example of acceleration and characteristics impedance in a case where a vibration is applied in the X direction to a connector according to the embodiment of the present invention;

[0022] FIG. 7 is a figure depicting an example of acceleration and characteristics impedance in a case where a vibration is applied in the Y direction to a connector according to the embodiment of the present invention;

[0023] FIG. **8** is a figure depicting an example of a threshold setting screen according to the embodiment of the present invention; and

[0024] FIG. **9** is a side view of the configuration of the electronic device according to a modification example of the embodiment of the present invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0025] Hereinbelow, an electronic device and an electronic device control method according to an embodiment (hereinafter, called the “present example”) of the present invention are explained with reference to the attached figures.

Configuration of Electronic Device

[0026] FIG. **1** and FIG. **2** depict the configuration of an electronic device **100** in the present example.

[0027] FIG. **1** is a side-view configuration diagram of the electronic device **100**, and FIG. **2** is a top-view configuration diagram of the electronic device **100**.

[0028] As depicted in FIG. **2**, the electronic device **100** is a storage apparatus including a plurality of drives **120** inside a housing **101**. Whereas the electronic device **100** includes eight drives **120** in the example in FIG. **2**, the number of the drives **120**, which is eight, is an example, and the number of the drives **120** is not necessarily eight.

[0029] For example, the drives **120** are configured using SSDs, and large volumes of data are stored on recording media (semiconductor memories) built in the SSDs.

[0030] As depicted in FIG. **1**, data transfer between a recording medium in each drive **120** and an external device is controlled by controllers **131** and **141** disposed on control boards **130** and **140**.

[0031] For example, as depicted in FIG. **1** and FIG. **2**, the exchange of data **d1** is performed between the controller **131** and the drive **120**, and the data transfer between the controller **131** and the drive **120** is controlled. For example, the controllers **131** and **141** are configured using central processing units (CPUs) and memories.

[0032] The two controllers **131** and **141** are prepared for giving the electronic device **100** redundancy. Either one of them executes data transfer control, and the other of them stands by in preparation for a situation where the control cannot be executed by the one of them occurs.

[0033] Whereas FIG. **2** depicts the flow of the data **d1** between the controller **131** and one drive **120**, the controller **131** actually controls all the arranged drives **120**.

[0034] Note that, in FIG. **1** and FIG. **2**, arrows represent data flows on the control board **130**, which is one of the control boards, and data flows of the control board **140**, which is the other of the control boards, are omitted. It is needless to say that data flows that are seen when the control board **140** is in operation are similar to data flows on the control board **130**.

[0035] The plurality of drives **120** and the two control boards **130** and **140** are connected to a backboard **110** in the housing **101** via respective connectors.

[0036] That is, a connector **121** is attached to each drive **120**, and the connector **121** is fit into a connector **113** on the side of the backboard **110**. In addition, connectors **133** are attached to the control board **130**, and the connectors **133** are fit into connectors **111** on the side of the backboard **110**. Similarly, connectors **143** are attached to the control board **140**, and the connectors **143** are fit into connectors **112** on the side of the backboard **110**.

[0037] Thereby, each drive **120** is electrically connected with the controllers **131** and **141** of the two control boards **130** and **140**.

[0038] In addition, respective ends of each drive **120** and the two control boards **130** and **140** are directly fixed to the housing **101** by screws **102**. In addition, the backboard **110** also is directly fixed to the housing **101** by screws **102**.

[0039] Then, in the electronic device **100** in the present example, an acceleration sensor **114** is attached to the backboard **110**. For example, the acceleration sensor **114** is attached to an end of the backboard **110**, and is disposed near a portion where the backboard **110** contacts the housing **101**.

[0040] The acceleration sensor **114** attached to the backboard **110** is a sensor that detects the

acceleration applied to the electronic device **100**. Acceleration detection data **d2** sensed by the acceleration sensor **114** is supplied to vibration sensing processing sections **132** and **142** disposed on the control boards **130** and **140**, respectively.

[0041] In the electronic device according to the present example, the vibration sensing processing sections **132** and **142** disposed respectively on the control boards **130** and **140** are circuits that perform vibration sensing process. The vibration sensing processing sections **132** and **142** are chips what are called microcomputers, and also perform other operation control of the control boards **130** and **140**. For example, the vibration sensing processing sections **132** and **142** also perform power management of the respective control boards **130** and **140**.

[0042] The vibration sensing processing sections **132** and **142** give a notification **d3** to the controllers **131** and **141** when the acceleration detection data **d2** from the acceleration sensor **114** has exceeded a set threshold. The controllers **131** and **141** having received the notification change the state of communication of each drive **120**. Details of the control process based on acceleration detection are mentioned later.

Configuration for Control Based on Acceleration Detection

[0043] FIG. **3** depicts a configuration for performing a process at the control board **130** on the basis of the acceleration detection data from the acceleration sensor **114**. Note that whereas the following explanation depicts the configuration and a process performed by the control board **130**, which is one of the control boards, the same applies also to the configuration of the control board **140**, which is the other of the control boards.

[0044] The vibration sensing processing section **132** includes a sensor information acquiring section **132a**, a threshold deciding processing section **132b**, a log processing section **132c**, and a vibration sensing transmitting section **132d**.

[0045] The controller **131** includes a drive interface (drive I/F) **131a** and an interrupt processing section **131b**. In addition, the controller **131** is connected with a memory **131c**. For example, as the memory **131c**, a memory module called a dual inline memory module (DIMM) in which a plurality of semiconductor memory chips are mounted on a printed board is used. Then, the memory **131c** is used as a cache memory.

[0046] Drives **120-1** to **120-N** (**N** is an integer: the number of drives mounted on the electronic device **100**) include storage sections **122-1** to **122-N**, respectively.

[0047] The sensor information acquiring section **132a** of the vibration sensing processing section **132** performs a process of acquiring the acceleration detection data from the acceleration sensor **114**.

[0048] The threshold deciding processing section **132b** performs a threshold deciding process of deciding whether or not an acceleration acquired by the sensor information acquiring section **132a** has exceeded thresholds. The thresholds used for the decision include an upper-limit threshold and a lower-limit threshold. Although appropriate values are set in advance as the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold, the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold can be modified by a threshold setting process mentioned later.

[0049] The log processing section **132c** executes a log process of controlling data transfer of the drive **120** by the controller **131**.

[0050] In a case where the threshold deciding processing section **132b** decides that the acceleration has exceeded a threshold, the vibration sensing transmitting section **132d** transmits a vibration sensing notification based on the log process at the log processing section **132c** to the interrupt processing section **131b** of the controller **131**.

[0051] When receiving the vibration sensing notification from the vibration sensing transmitting section **132d**, the interrupt processing section **131b** of the controller **131** changes the state of communication of the respective drives **120-1** to **120-N**, which is set by the controller **131**.

[0052] The drive I/F **131a** of the controller **131** is in the state of communication set by the controller **131**, and executes communication with the respective drives **120-1** to **120-N**.

[0053] Note that data written in the storage sections **122-1** to **122-N** of the drives **120-1** to **120-N**, and data read out from the storage sections **122-1** to **122-N** can be temporarily stored on the memory **131c** connected to the controller **131**.

Control Process at Time of Occurrence of Vibration

[0054] FIG. **4** is a flowchart depicting the control based on acceleration detection by the vibration sensing processing section **132**.

[0055] In a case where the threshold deciding processing section **132b** has determined that the acceleration has exceeded the upper-limit threshold, the vibration sensing processing section **132** starts a process to be performed at the time of occurrence of a vibration (Step **S11**).

[0056] When the process to be performed at the time of occurrence of a vibration is started, the vibration sensing transmitting section **132d** starts log acquisition at the log processing section **132c**, and notifies the controller **131** of a transmission stop event (Step **S12**).

[0057] The controller **131** that received the transmission stop event notified at Step **S12** performs a process of causing the state of link between the controller **131** and the drive **120** to transition, and temporarily stopping data transfer (temporary stop process) (Step **S13**).

[0058] Then, in the vibration sensing processing section **132**, the threshold deciding processing section **132b** determines whether or not the acceleration has become smaller than the lower-limit threshold (Step **S14**).

[0059] In a case where it is determined at Step **S14** that the acceleration has become smaller than the lower-limit threshold (YES at Step **S14**), the vibration sensing processing section **132** ends the log acquisition at the log processing section **132c**, and notifies the controller **131** of a transmission resumption event (Step **S15**).

[0060] The controller **131** having received the transmission resumption event causes the state of link between the controller **131** and the drive **120** to transition, and causes the data transfer to resume (Step **S16**). Thereby, the process to be performed at the time of occurrence of a vibration ends. The end in a state where the resumption at Step **S16** has been performed is an end at the time of a normal state.

[0061] Note that transfer-target data from stopping of the data transfer at Step **S13** until resumption of the data transfer at Step **S16** is temporarily stored on the memory **131c** connected to the controller **131**. Accordingly, when the data transfer is resumed in step **S16**, the data transfer is executed using the data cached in the memory **131c**.

[0062] In addition, when the acceleration is not smaller than the lower-limit threshold at Step **S14** (NO at Step **S14**), the vibration sensing processing section **132** determines whether or not the elapsed time since the notification of the transmission stop event at Step **S12** has exceeded preset maximum stop time (Step **S17**). For example, the maximum stop time is set on the basis of an amount of data that can be cached in the memory **131c**, and is approximately several seconds.

[0063] When it is determined at Step **S17** that the maximum stop time has not been exceeded (NO at Step **S17**), the vibration sensing processing section **132** returns to the determination at Step **S14**.

[0064] Then, when it is determined at Step **S17** that the maximum stop time is exceeded (YES at Step **S17**), the vibration sensing processing section **132** performs a process of stopping the drive **120** (Step **S18**), and ends the process to be performed at the time of occurrence of a vibration. The end in a state where the stop process at Step **S18** has been performed is an end at the time of an abnormal state. At Step **S18**, instead of the vibration sensing processing section **132**, the controller **131** may stop the drive **120**. In this case, the vibration sensing processing section **132** notifies the controller **131** of a stop process event, and the controller **131** having received the event stops the drive **120**.

[0065] FIG. **5** is a sequence diagram depicting a setting example of the state of communication. It is assumed here that the acceleration sensor **114** has sensed a significant vibration due to occurrence of an earthquake or the like.

[0066] When the acceleration sensor **114** senses a significant vibration (Step **S101**), and an

acceleration sensed by the vibration sensing processing section **132** exceeds the upper-limit threshold (Step **S102**), the vibration sensing processing section **132** gives a notification to the controller **131** (Step **S103**). The controller **131** having received the notification that the acceleration has exceeded the upper-limit threshold (Step **S104**) gives a state-of-communication transition instruction (Step **S105**).

[0067] According to the state-of-communication transition instruction given at Step **S105**, the controller **131** changes the state of communication of the drive **120** from a normal state (**S111**) to a stop state (**S112**). At this time, there is a possibility that normal data transfer cannot be performed because of an occurrence of abnormalities such as a variation of the characteristics impedance or chattering due to a change in the contact state of the connectors caused by a propagation, with a slight delay, of a significant vibration due to an earthquake or the like to the connectors **121** and **113**, for example. During the stop state at Step **S112**, data transfer between the controller **131** and the drive **120** is stopped temporarily. Data during this stop state is cached in the memory **131c** connected to the controller **131**.

[0068] Then, when the acceleration sensor **114** senses an attenuation of the vibration due to the damping of the vibration (Step **S121**), and the acceleration sensed by the vibration sensing processing section **132** becomes smaller than the lower-limit threshold (Step **S122**), the vibration sensing processing section **132** gives the controller **131** a notification (Step **S123**). The controller **131** having received the notification that the acceleration has become smaller than the lower-limit threshold (Step **S124**) gives a state-of-communication transition instruction (Step **S125**).

[0069] According to the state-of-communication transition instruction given at Step **S125**, the controller **131** changes the state of communication of the drives **120** from the stop state (**S112**) to the normal state (**S113**). As a result of the change to the normal state, the data transfer by the drives **120** is resumed.

[0070] As explained above, according to the electronic device **100** in the present example, at the time of temporary occurrence of a vibration due to an earthquake or the like, data transfer at the drives **120** gets stopped automatically by the vibration being sensed, and is resumed automatically when the vibration is damped. Note that when the end process at the time of an abnormal state at Step **S18** in the flowchart in FIG. **4** is performed, a resumption process which is similar to those performed in conventional techniques is necessary. It should be noted that, in this case also, by analysis of data cached in the memory **131c** connected to the controller **131**, it can be determined to which point the data transfer has been performed, and it becomes possible to perform a resumption process which is more appropriate and takes a shorter time than in conventional techniques.

Example of Setting of Upper-Limit Threshold and Lower-Limit Threshold

[0071] Next, an example of setting of the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold to be used at the time of occurrence of a vibration is explained. FIG. **6** depicts an example of a case where a vibration is applied in the X direction to a connection portion between a connector **111** attached to the backboard **110** of the electronic device **100** and a connector **133** on the side of the control board **130** in the present example. In addition, FIG. **7** depicts an example of a case where a vibration is applied to the same connection portion in the Y direction, which is 90°-perpendicular to the X direction. The X direction and the Y direction are illustrated in FIG. **6D** and FIG. **7D**.

[0072] The vertical axes in FIG. **6A** and FIG. **7A** represent the accelerations of the vibrations applied to the electronic device **100**, and the horizontal axes represent time. In addition, the vertical axes in FIG. **6B** and FIG. **7B** represent displacement amounts (mm) in the X direction and the Y direction in a case where the vibrations are applied to the electronic device **100**, and the horizontal axes represent time.

[0073] As depicted in FIG. **6B** and FIG. **7B**, it can be known that the displacement amounts in the respective directions increase as the accelerations increase.

[0074] In FIG. **6A** and FIG. **7A**, the upper-limit threshold is written as TH1, and the lower-limit threshold is written as TH2. The upper-limit threshold TH1 in FIG. **6A** and FIG. **7A** corresponds to

a value $\alpha 2$ to be used when the displacement amounts in the respective directions in FIG. 6B and FIG. 7B are relatively large. In addition, the lower-limit threshold TH2 in FIG. 6A and FIG. 7A corresponds to a value $\alpha 1$ to be used when the displacement amounts in the respective directions in FIG. 6B and FIG. 7B are relatively small.

[0075] FIG. 6C and FIG. 7C depict the relationships between the displacement amounts (horizontal axes) in the respective directions and the characteristics impedance (vertical axes) of the connectors, and the characteristics impedance increases as the displacement amounts increase to $\alpha 2$ and then to $\alpha 3$. The value of the displacement amount $\alpha 3$ is a displacement amount at which the connectors get disengaged.

[0076] Here, the values of the displacement amounts $\alpha 1$ and $\alpha 2$ are set such that a characteristics impedance value $\beta 1$, which is obtained by tolerating change to predetermined N% in the characteristics impedance value at the time of displacement amounts being zero, corresponds to the displacement amount $\alpha 2$. The impedance N% at the time of displacement amounts being zero is the upper limit of the displacement amounts, where transmission performance can be ensured by transmission analysis.

[0077] Thereby, it becomes possible for the vibration sensing processing section 132 to appropriately set the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold to such values that errors do not occur in data transfer due to a vibration at the time of occurrence of an earthquake.

Example of Screen for Setting Upper-Limit Threshold and Lower-Limit Threshold

[0078] Note that it is preferable if the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold are preset to appropriate values by the process mentioned above, but may be allowed to be modified on a setting screen or the like of the electronic device 100.

[0079] FIG. 8 depicts an example of a screen for setting the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold. As depicted in FIG. 8, a user is allowed to input a sensing threshold (start) which is the upper-limit threshold, and a sensing threshold (end) which is the lower-limit threshold on the setting screen.

[0080] In the example in FIG. 8, the sensing threshold (START) which is the upper-limit threshold is set to 3 G (G is the unit of gravitational acceleration), and the sensing threshold (END) which is the lower-limit threshold is set to 0.1 G. Since there is a possibility that the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold change depending on the installation position of the acceleration sensor 114, the installation position of the acceleration sensor is also displayed on the setting screen in FIG. 8. That is, the installation position is displayed as “MOUNTING POSITION: BACKBOARD” on the setting screen.

[0081] In addition, it is made possible to modify also the maximum elapsed time on the setting screen. The maximum elapsed time is the maximum stop time determined at Step S17 in the flowchart in FIG. 4, and is determined by the storage capacity of the memory 131c and the like.

[0082] In this manner, by making it possible to modify the upper-limit threshold and lower-limit threshold of an acceleration, the electronic device in the present example can cope with various installation conditions. In addition, since the maximum elapsed time (maximum stop time) can be modified, it becomes possible to set appropriate stop time depending on conditions such as memory capacity or a data transfer speed.

Another Example of Installation Position of Acceleration Sensor

[0083] In the example depicted in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2, the acceleration sensor 114 is attached to the backboard 110. By providing the acceleration sensor 114 to the backboard 110, there are provided advantages of enabling a plurality of the control boards 130 and 140 to share the acceleration sensor 114, and enabling a vibration externally applied to the housing 101 to be appropriately sensed. However, acceleration sensors may be installed at other positions.

[0084] FIG. 9 depicts an example in which acceleration sensors are attached to the control boards 130 and 140.

[0085] In the example in FIG. 9, the control board 130, which is one of the control boards, includes

an acceleration sensor **134**, and the control board **140**, which is the other of the control boards, includes an acceleration sensor **144**.

[0086] For example, it is preferable if the respective acceleration sensors **134** and **144** are provided at portions to which external vibrations are transferred easily, and which are near portions where the control boards **130** and **140** are fixed to the housing **101** by the screws **102**.

[0087] Thereby, it becomes possible for the vibration sensing processing sections **132** and **142** disposed on the control boards **130** and **140** to directly sense vibrations from the acceleration sensors **134** and **144** in the boards. In other respects, the configuration of the electronic device **100** in FIG. **9** is similar to the configuration of the electronic device **100** depicted in FIG. **1** and FIG. **2**.

[0088] In a case of the configuration depicted in FIG. **9**, the acceleration sensors **134** and **144** are attached to the control boards **130** and **140**. Accordingly, processing for attaching an acceleration sensor on the side of the backboard **110** becomes unnecessary. In addition, the vibration sensing processing sections **132** and **142** are directly supplied with measurement values of the acceleration sensors bypassing the connectors, and thus it becomes possible to determine acceleration values more appropriately.

Other Modification Examples

[0089] Note that the embodiment explained thus far has been explained in detail in order to explain the present invention in an easy-to-understand manner, and the present invention is not necessarily limited to an embodiment including all the constituent elements explained. For example, whereas the present invention is applied to a storage apparatus including a plurality of drives in the example depicted in the embodiment mentioned above, the present invention may be applied to the other electronic devices.

[0090] In addition, only control lines and information lines that are considered to be necessary for explanation are depicted in the configuration diagram depicted in FIG. **3**, all control lines and information line for a product are not necessarily depicted. Actually, it may be considered that almost all the constituent elements are interconnected.

[0091] In addition, the processing procedure depicted in the flowchart FIG. **4** also is an example, and, as long as the same processing results are produced, the processing order may be partially modified, or a plurality of processes may be executed simultaneously.

[0092] In addition, the control process depicted in FIG. **4** is executed by a program implemented on the vibration sensing processing section **132**, and the vibration sensing processing section can cause a general-purpose information processing apparatus (microcomputer) to function by causing the general-purpose information processing apparatus to implement the relevant program.

Regarding the program in this case, other than being prepared in a memory in an information processing apparatus as the vibration sensing processing section **132**, it may be placed on a recording medium such as an external memory, an IC card, an SD card, or an optical disc, and may be transferred.

[0093] Furthermore, part or the whole of the vibration sensing processing section may be realized by dedicated hardware such as a field programmable gate array (FPGA) or an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC).

Claims

1. An electronic device in which a drive that stores data and a control board having disposed thereon a controller that controls data transfer between the drive and another apparatus are connected to each other via a connector, the electronic device comprising: an acceleration sensor that senses occurrence of a vibration; and a vibration sensing processing section that controls a state of communication between the drive and the controller to temporarily stop data transfer performed by the drive, when the acceleration sensor has sensed an acceleration exceeding an upper-limit threshold, and causes the temporarily stopped data transfer to resume when the

acceleration sensor has sensed an acceleration of equal to or lower than a lower-limit threshold.

2. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the vibration sensing processing section causes the controller to change a state of communication with the drive from a normal state to a data transfer stopped state, and to change the state of communication with the drive to the normal state at a time of resumption.

3. The electronic device according to claim 2, wherein, during the data transfer stopped state, a memory disposed on the control board accumulates data being transferred, and, after the resumption of the temporarily stopped data transfer, the data accumulated in the memory is transferred to the drive.

4. The electronic device according to claim 3, wherein the electronic device is stopped when it has become impossible for the memory to accumulate data.

5. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the drive and the control board are mounted on a backboard attached to a housing, and the acceleration sensor is disposed on the backboard.

6. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the drive and the control board are mounted on a backboard attached to a housing, and further, part of the control board is attached to the housing by a screw, and the acceleration sensor is disposed near a portion where the screw is attached on the control board.

7. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the vibration sensing processing section allows the upper-limit threshold and the lower-limit threshold to be modified by an external instruction.

8. An electronic device control method applied to an electronic device in which a drive that stores data and a control board having disposed thereon a controller that controls data transfer between the drive and another apparatus are connected to each other via a connector, the electronic device control method comprising: a temporary stop process of temporarily stopping data transfer performed by the drive, when an acceleration sensed by an acceleration sensor that senses occurrence of a vibration exceeds an upper-limit threshold; and, after the temporary stop process, a resumption process of causing the temporarily stopped data transfer to resume when the acceleration sensor has sensed an acceleration of equal to or lower than a lower-limit threshold.
